



What Could Happen: An EdTech Platform's Section 9 Exposure

Imagine a platform like yours — millions of young learners, rapid growth, and a looming **DPDPA Section 9** compliance gap. This is a realistic scenario illustrating the kind of crisis **DPDPA Shield by ZeroShield** is built to prevent. Consider how verifiable parental consent failures and unchecked behavioural profiling could unfold — and how they can be solved.

Presented By

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Illustrative Scenario Focus

A hypothetical EdTech platform navigating **DPDPA 2023, Section 9** & **DPDP Rules 2025, Rule 10** — and how it could have been protected.

The EdTech Minor Data Challenge in India

Personalised Learning for a Vulnerable Cohort

The Hypothetical: "EduKid India"

Consider a platform we'll call "**EduKid India**" — a fictional but entirely realistic EdTech company. Picture a fast-growing K-12 app with **1.2 million registered students**, of whom **40% are under 18**. Data processed includes daily learning performance, mock test logs, biometric telemetry, facial video scans, and tutor chat records — a rich but highly sensitive data estate. This represents the kind of platform operating across India today.

The DPDPA Section 9 Mandate

Section 9(1)

Processing personal data of any child under 18 requires **verifiable parental or lawful guardian consent** before any data collection begins.

Section 9(3)

Complete prohibition on tracking, behavioural monitoring, or targeted advertising directed at children in any form.

Detrimental Effect Ban

Processing must not cause any detrimental effect on the **well-being of the child** — a broad, principle-based duty of care.

What Could Go Wrong

The Risks & Compliance Gaps a Platform Like EduKid Faces Without Action

₹200Cr

Potential Penalty Exposure

Without remediation, a platform like EduKid faces up to ₹200 Crores in statutory fines — one of the DPDPA's highest penalty thresholds, reserved specifically for child data violations.

Zero

Audit Trail Readiness

Legacy systems typically have zero cryptographic proof linking a minor's record to a parent's verified identity token — exactly what a regulator would look for first.

Common Gaps an Audit Could Uncover in Platforms Like This

Self-Declaration Bypass

Many legacy systems rely entirely on a text field — "I am over 18" or a parent's email — with zero verification. This is trivially bypassed by any user and immediately indefensible under Section 9(1).

Behavioural Ad Profiling

Without intervention, downstream marketing engines continue pushing targeted advertisements to minor students based on course browsing behaviour — a direct and ongoing violation of Section 9(3).

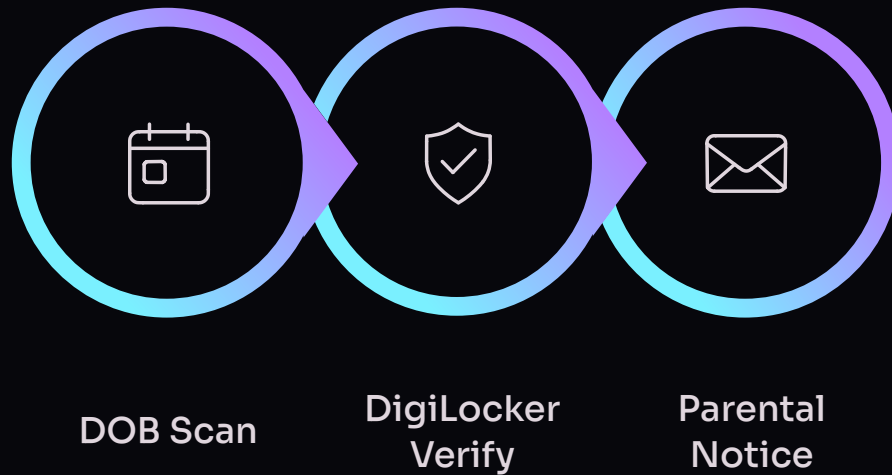
No Cryptographic Proof

The absence of a verifiable link between a minor's account and a parent's authenticated identity makes any consent claim legally indefensible the moment a regulator or auditor asks for evidence.

⊗ This is a live, unmitigated risk for thousands of EdTech platforms operating in India today — and it's exactly what **DPDPA Shield** is designed to prevent.

How DPDPA Shield Would Solve It

DPDPA Shield's Verifiable Parental Consent (VPC) Module Would Architect the Solution



DPDPA Shield's VPC architecture would create an end-to-end, cryptographically verifiable chain of consent. By connecting to the platform's database, the system would automatically identify minor records by date-of-birth, route consent requests through DigiLocker's authorised identity portal, and store tamper-proof verification tokens in the **Proof Vault**. Every parent would receive a compliant Section 5 notice detailing exactly what data is collected and how to exercise withdrawal rights.



The Zero-Tracking Enforcement API — What DPDPA Shield Deploys

Programmatic Anti-Profiling Safeguards DPDPA Shield Would Enforce under Section 9(3)

How the API Would Work

DPDPA Shield would deploy a **Zero-Tracking API** that every downstream system — ad servers, recommender engines, and CRM tools — would be required to query before initiating any processing of a user session. When a student ID resolves to a verified minor, the API would respond immediately with a strict `allowed: false` flag, halting all downstream processing unconditionally.

What the System Would Enforce Automatically

→ Ad-Profiling Block

All third-party pixels — including Meta Pixel and Google Tag Manager — would be **completely blocked** from loading for any minor session, with no manual intervention required.

→ Push Notification Exclusion

Minor IDs would be automatically excluded from all behavioural triggers, including mock test score-based push notifications that could constitute profiling under the Act.

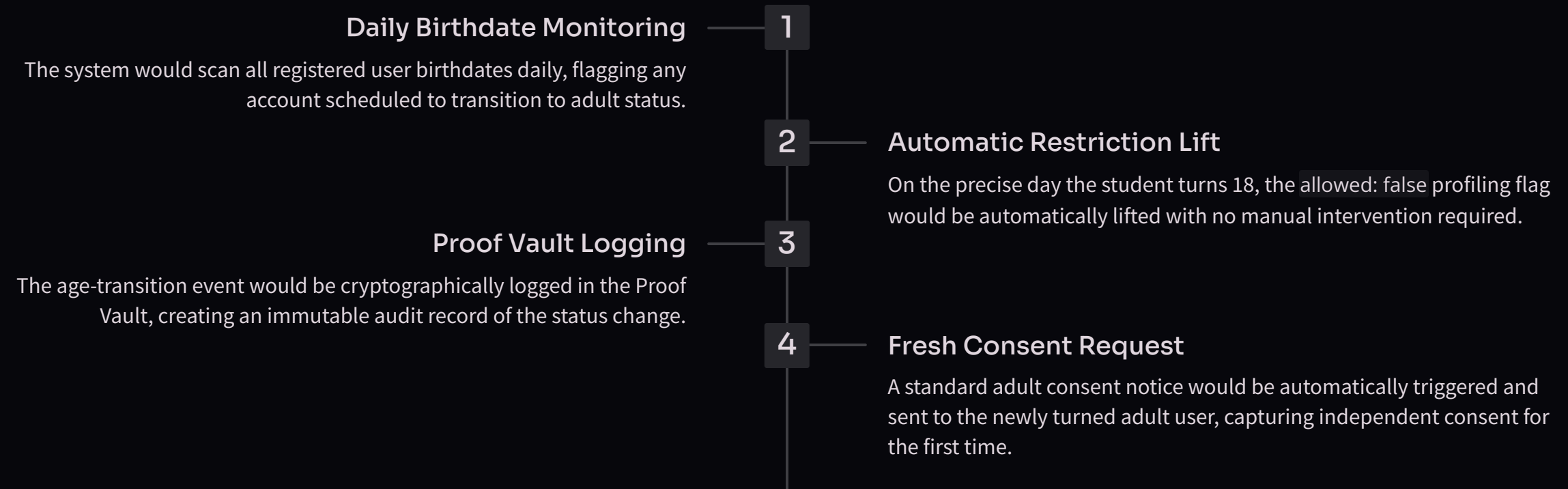
→ CRM Gating

Third-party CRM integrations would be hard-gated by the API, preventing any external tool from receiving or processing minor student data at the point of origin.

Automated Age-Transition Workflows

How DPDPA Shield Handles the 18th Birthday — Automatically

One of the most operationally complex challenges in managing a minor data estate is the **graceful transition** to adult status — lifting restrictions without disrupting years of learning history or creating a compliance gap. DPDPA Shield's Transition Engine would resolve this entirely through automation.



- ❏ The Transition Engine would preserve the full learning history of the student whilst cleanly separating the minor-era consent records from the new adult consent lifecycle — with zero manual DPO intervention.

Projected Outcomes with DPDPA Shield

What a Platform Like EduKid Could Achieve

96%

Target Compliance Posture Score

Platforms deploying DPDPA Shield can realistically target a 96% posture map score, fully resolving all identified Section 9 risks within a single implementation cycle.

92K+

Parental Consents Verifiable

At scale, over 92,000 parental consent records could be verified via DigiLocker within the first quarter of deployment alone.

100%

Tracker Blocking for Minors

Third-party trackers would remain completely blocked for all minor accounts — guaranteed by the Zero-Tracking API architecture — preventing full ₹200 Crore penalty exposure.

+25%

Potential Partnership Growth

A "Verifiably Safe Processing" certification status could drive a 25% increase in new school partnership acquisitions, turning compliance into a commercial advantage.

DPO Peace of Mind

DPDPA Shield would automatically generate **Deletion Certificates** for inactive minor records, eliminating manual DPO intervention and providing auditable proof of data lifecycle compliance at scale — with zero operational overhead.

Certified Platform Status

EduKid could become a recognised **"Verifiably Safe Processing"** platform — a market differentiator that would directly support commercial growth, regulatory confidence, and long-term brand trust with educational institutions and parents alike.

This is the outcome DPDPA Shield is built to deliver.